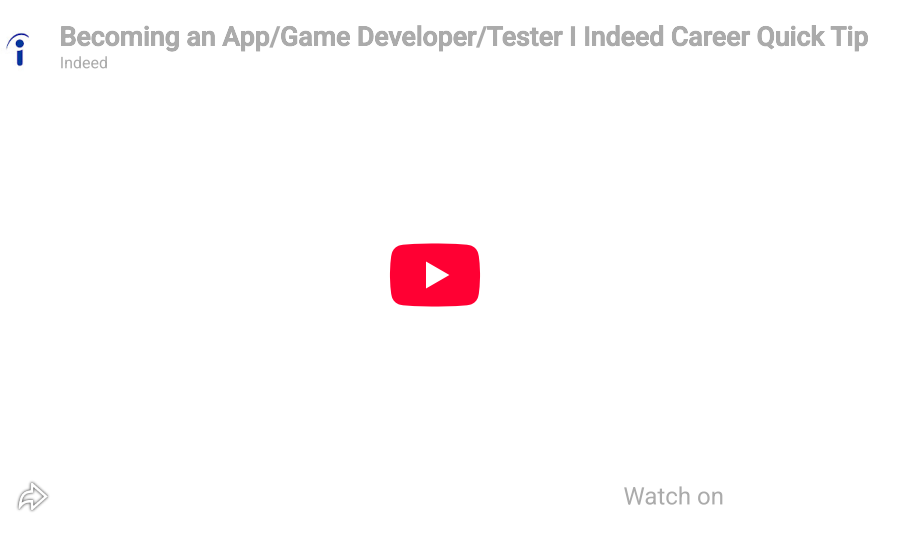
What Is a Mobile App Developer? (With Key Duties and Salary)

Written by Indeed Editorial Team

Updated June 16, 2026

On this page

For employers: Post a Job on Indeed



Show Transcript

Video: Becoming an App and Game Developer/Tester

Are you interested in a career as an App and Game Developer/Tester but are not sure how to start preparing for it? We have you covered!

KEY TAKEAWAYS:

- Learning about what an app developer does and other key considerations for the job can help you determine if it's an appealing career opportunity for you.
- When seeking work as a mobile app developer, it's common for employers to request a minimum of a bachelor's degree in computer science, computer programming or a related field.
- A mobile app developer is a software professional who creates applications for smartphones and other mobile devices.

Mobile application development is a growing field for both independent and corporate developers. If you're interested in a career as a software developer, you may consider working in application development. Learning about what an app developer does and other key considerations for the job can help you determine if it's an appealing career opportunity for you. In this article, we discuss what a mobile app developer is, what they do, requirements to work in the field and the salary expectations and industry outlook for mobile app developers.

Find your next job more quickly

Job seekers who use Indeed Career Scout are 38% more likely to get hired

Try Career Scout

Source: Indeed test data, US, May 2025, based on the average hires per apply

What is a mobile app developer?

A mobile app developer is a software professional who creates applications for smartphones and other mobile devices. This may include creating mobile versions of web or computer-based applications. It may also involve generating applications designed specifically as mobile-exclusive software. Mobile app developers may work for a software development firm or independently through contract work.

Related: What Is an Application Developer?

Related jobs on Indeed

Android developers jobs ›

Part-time jobs ›

Full-time jobs ›

Remote jobs ›

View more jobs on Indeed →

What does a mobile app developer do

When working as a mobile app developer, your responsibilities may vary based on the role you have within the team. Common duties for a mobile app developer include:

- Meeting with senior employees of an employer or with representatives of a client, to discuss the application and their desired features, schedule and budget
- Taking part in brainstorming sessions to discuss potential ideas to include in an application's design
- Creating a project plan for the coding, testing and release of the application
- Writing code for an application
- Debugging code to identify the cause of errors when executing a program and fixing them
- Developing and releasing patches to an application to correct errors
- Updating applications with new features and modes to provide enhanced value to users

Related: How To Become an App Developer

Education and training for mobile app developers

When seeking work as a mobile app developer, it's common for employers to request a minimum of a bachelor's degree in computer science, computer programming or a related field. An employer may also request or value professional certifications in one or more programming languages to show you're competent coding in their preferred language. When working as an independent mobile application developer, you don't need to earn a formal degree. However, you may still benefit from attending a college or university or completing online courses to improve your coding and application design knowledge.

Salary and job outlook for mobile app developers

The average salary for a mobile application developer is $120,221 per year. The expanding presence of mobile use projects to contribute to growth in the field in the years to come. The Bureau of Labor Statistics doesn't have data specifically for mobile app developers, however, it projects a 22% growth from 2020 to 2030 for software developers, quality assurance analysts and testers.

Related: App Developer Salary Guide: Jobs, Descriptions and Salaries

Mobile app developer skills

When pursuing a career as a mobile app developer, it may be beneficial to develop skills that apply to the position. These skills include:

Adaptability

When working on a mobile application, you may face a situation in which you must respond to unforeseen circumstances. This may occur because of an unexpected change to new expectations from your employer or client or because of application needs identified during the coding process. Adaptability allows you to respond to unexpected occurrences effectively and maintain high standards for your work.

Analytical ability

Analytical ability allows you to assess a situation and come to accurate and meaningful conclusions from the information available to you. As an application developer, the ability to analyze effectively is an important skill both when designing and creating applications. During the design process, analytical ability may allow you to identify beneficial features to include in your application. When working on a project, analysis allows you to examine progress and identify areas for improvement or potential solutions to problems.

Communication

The ability to communicate well with others, both verbally and in written form, can be beneficial to an application developer. During the design process, clear communication ensures that all parties understand each other and there's a unified vision for the project before moving forward into execution. During development, clear communication allows you to speak with your employer, clients or others on the development team to discuss progress and make or update plans for the continued development of the application.

Computer programming

Understanding one or more coding languages is a core competency for a mobile application developer. When working for an employer, they're likely to request specific languages that their development team uses on their project. Being able to build comfortably with a range of programming languages may expand your options when seeking work as a mobile application developer.

Creativity

Creativity allows you to develop interesting and appealing solutions to challenges. As a mobile application developer, strong creative ability may help you design a mobile application that's appealing to users. You may also use your creativity during the debugging and troubleshooting phase of a project , as it may allow you to identify potential solutions to problems. This allows you to pursue the option that you believe provides the most appealing results.

Dedicated learning

As a professional developer, it may be beneficial to be dedicated to continuing your education even after finding professional work. The software development field is continuously changing, with new expectations and capabilities always in development. By continuing to learn, you keep yourself aligned with the most recent developments in the field, which can make you a more appealing candidate for positions and help you develop applications that are useful to consumers.

Problem-solving

Problem-solving skills allow you to look at a situation, identify a problem and then develop potential solutions to it. As a mobile application developer, you may encounter situations in which you need to make corrections to your code or alterations to plans to allow the application to function properly. Strong problem-solving skills can be beneficial in these situations and make you a more effective mobile app developer.

Teamwork

Although a mobile app developer may work as a solo developer, it's common for application developers to work as a part of a team. This allows for the creation of large apps with many functions and features, which would otherwise require an excessive development time when produced by a single developer. Teamwork skills allow you to work well with others on your team, allowing you and your teammates to maximize your individual talents within the collective effort.

Related: Mobile App Developer Skills: Definition and Examples

Search jobs and companies hiring now

Job title, keywords or company

Location

Search

Work environment for mobile app developers

A mobile app developer may work in a variety of settings. As an independent developer, you may work at home or rent office space. You may also meet with clients at their places of business. When working as a mobile app developer for an employer, you may work remotely or may complete most of your work in an office. You may also spend time in meeting rooms taking part in or leading meetings, and you may visit clients at their place of business to discuss your applications.

The information on this site is provided as a courtesy and for informational purposes only. Indeed is not a career or legal advisor and does not guarantee job interviews or offers.

Related Articles



What Is Mobile Engineering? (Plus 4 Related Careers)



Web Developer vs. Software Developer: What's the Difference?



FAQ: What Degree Does a Software Developer Need?

1 / 4

Explore more articles

10 Skills You Need To Ace Your Next Interview

12 Pros and Cons of Being an Event Manager (With Job Duties)

How To Use Resume Keywords and Phrases (With Example)

What Degree Does a Pilot Need? (With 8 Degree Options)

How to Improve Your Resume with Professional Affiliations

How To Do Well in a Meeting the Team Interview

How To Write a Summary of Qualifications (With Examples)

7 Types of Jobs in Video Editing (With Salaries)

What To Say to Someone Who Didn't Get a Promotion or Job

10 Skills To Become Technology Savvy (Plus Helpful Tips)

How To Search for Remote Work on Indeed

Communication Mediums: 5 Types (Plus Choosing the Right One)

Hiring Lab
Career advice
Browse jobs
Browse companies
Salaries
Indeed Events
Work at Indeed
Countries
About
Help
ESG at Indeed
Download app
© 2026 Indeed
Your Privacy Choices
Accessibility at Indeed
Privacy Center and Ad Choices
Terms